Purpose

This document summarizes the fake-name assets and the market news used in the Youth Financetopia Challenge. The student-facing game should use the fake asset names only. The real-asset references below are for facilitator context and calibration.

Fake Asset Mapping

Student-facing name	Real-world trace	Type	Game role
Stock A	Meta Platforms / Facebook	Equity	Advertising, privacy, social-platform growth, and rate-sensitivity proxy
Stock B	Occidental Petroleum	Equity	Leveraged energy equity and balance-sheet stress proxy
Stock C	Eli Lilly	Equity	Defensive healthcare and drug-catalyst proxy
Metal D	Gold	Commodity	Safe-haven metal, real-yield, dollar, and war-risk proxy
Energy E	Crude oil, mainly WTI	Commodity	Oil supply, demand, storage, sanctions, and war-premium proxy
FX Pair F	EUR/USD	FX	Dollar cycle and rate-differential proxy
Fear Gauge G	VIX volatility index	Indicator	Market stress indicator; visible but not directly tradable

The game prices are simplified quarterly proxy traces for 2018-2022. They are based on real historical direction and magnitude, but they are rounded for gameplay and are not exact official market closes.

Facilitator Notes

- Students should not be told the real-world mapping during the game unless the activity is designed as a debrief.
- Rumors are intentionally fictionalized. They are designed to create uncertainty and discussion, not to represent verified news.
- Some assets do not receive a news card every year. That is intentional; students should learn that incomplete information is part of decision-making.
- Fear Gauge G is an indicator. It can help teams interpret stress regimes but is not directly tradable.

Annual News Summary

2018

Stock A

News signal: A privacy scandal and slower user growth hurt the social-platform proxy while the wider market sold off late in the year.

Rumor: Regulators may force an expensive product redesign.

Trading interpretation: Growth quality is under question. Teams should think about regulatory risk, ad-model fragility, and whether the selloff creates value or signals deeper damage.

Stock B

News signal: Energy-linked equities rallied with crude early, then weakened sharply as oversupply fears returned in Q4.

Rumor: Management may be looking for a large acquisition.

Trading interpretation: The asset is exposed to both commodity price swings and corporate balance-sheet risk. A takeover or acquisition story can increase upside but also raises leverage concerns.

Stock C

News signal: The healthcare proxy advanced steadily as its core drug franchises expanded.

Rumor: Clinical-trial watchers think the pipeline is deeper than the market assumes.

Trading interpretation: This is a defensive compounder with potential catalyst upside. Teams should compare steady growth against richer valuation risk.

Metal D

News signal: Higher rates and a stronger dollar pressured the safe-haven metal before a year-end rebound.

Rumor: The late rebound may be only short covering.

Trading interpretation: Metal D is sensitive to real yields and dollar strength. It can protect portfolios during stress, but rallies may fade if macro pressure remains.

Energy E

News signal: Supply concerns pushed energy higher before Q4 oversupply fears caused a sharp reversal.

Rumor: Inventories may be building faster than headlines suggest.

Trading interpretation: Energy E can reverse quickly when the market shifts from shortage fear to surplus fear. Inventory data matters.

2019

Stock A

News signal: The social-platform proxy recovered as advertising demand stabilized despite recurring political pressure.

Rumor: Product-growth data may be improving in smaller markets.

Trading interpretation: The prior-year damage may have been overdone if engagement and ad demand recover. Political risk remains a valuation drag.

Stock B

News signal: A debt-heavy acquisition plan damaged confidence in the energy proxy.

Rumor: Credit desks think the dividend may become harder to defend.

Trading interpretation: The key risk is leverage. Even if energy prices hold up, debt, dividends, and acquisition integration can dominate returns.

Stock C

News signal: The healthcare proxy absorbed political drug-pricing pressure while buying a precision-medicine asset.

Rumor: Specialists think the acquisition may be strategically cheap if trials convert.

Trading interpretation: Policy risk competes with pipeline optionality. Teams should decide whether innovation can offset pricing pressure.

Metal D

News signal: Central-bank easing and trade-war uncertainty supported a strong metal rally.

Rumor: Real-money funds may be rebuilding safe-haven allocations.

Trading interpretation: Falling rates and uncertainty can support Metal D. Momentum may persist if macro fear and easier policy continue.

FX Pair F

News signal: Rate cuts and trade-war uncertainty pulled the currency pair through a choppy range.

Rumor: Macro traders are fading relief rallies until trade language changes.

Trading interpretation: FX Pair F is a macro confidence trade. Teams should watch relative central-bank policy and trade headlines.

2020

Stock A

News signal: The platform proxy fell in the COVID crash but rebounded with online advertising and e-commerce demand.

Rumor: Lockdown engagement may have spiked sharply.

Trading interpretation: Initial panic may create opportunity if digital behavior accelerates. Teams should separate temporary ad weakness from structural engagement gains.

Stock B

News signal: The energy proxy nearly broke under COVID demand destruction, negative oil, and acquisition debt.

Rumor: Lenders may demand asset sales.

Trading interpretation: This is a stress scenario. The asset may have high rebound potential, but survival and liquidity risk are central.

Stock C

News signal: The healthcare proxy behaved defensively and gained attention from an emergency-use treatment.

Rumor: One late-stage readout could change the growth story.

Trading interpretation: Defensive earnings plus medical catalysts can be valuable in a crisis. Teams should still evaluate trial uncertainty.

Metal D

News signal: Safe-haven metal briefly sold off for cash, then surged on stimulus and risk hedging.

Rumor: Macro investors are buying metal as a stimulus hedge.

Trading interpretation: In liquidity shocks, even safe havens can fall first. After policy support arrives, inflation and risk hedges can rally.

Energy E

News signal: Energy collapsed as demand disappeared and storage filled, then recovered after supply cuts.

Rumor: Physical storage constraints may be worse than screen prices imply.

Trading interpretation: Physical-market mechanics matter. Storage, demand destruction, and supply cuts can create extreme price moves.

2021

Stock A

News signal: The platform proxy reached a high before growth and identity-shift concerns appeared.

Rumor: A major rebrand could distract management.

Trading interpretation: Momentum is strong, but strategic pivots can create execution risk. Teams should ask whether growth is peaking.

Stock B

News signal: The energy proxy improved as reopening demand lifted crude.

Rumor: Value investors are quietly revisiting the balance-sheet story.

Trading interpretation: Reopening can repair distressed energy names quickly. The best returns may come when leverage risk starts to decline.

Stock C

News signal: Two major drug narratives lifted the healthcare proxy despite a risk-on market.

Rumor: Specialist doctors are discussing unusually strong trial data.

Trading interpretation: Product-specific catalysts can outperform macro style rotations. Teams should weigh catalyst strength against already-rising prices.

Fear Gauge G

News signal: Volatility faded from 2020 extremes but spiked around meme-stock and variant shocks.

Rumor: Retail call volume may be distorting risk readings.

Trading interpretation: Lower average volatility does not mean low event risk. Fear Gauge G helps teams identify stress pockets.

FX Pair F

News signal: The currency pair weakened gradually as rate expectations diverged.

Rumor: Macro funds are positioning for a stronger dollar cycle.

Trading interpretation: Relative policy expectations can drive FX trends. Teams should watch whether the market is pricing earlier or faster rate hikes.

2022

Stock A

News signal: The platform proxy collapsed under privacy changes, slowing users, heavy investment, and higher rates.

Rumor: Ad buyers say measurement issues may be worse than management admits.

Trading interpretation: Multiple compression and business-model concerns can reinforce each other. Teams should be careful with averaging down purely because the price has fallen.

Stock B

News signal: The energy proxy became a standout winner as war-risk premiums and investor accumulation lifted sentiment.

Rumor: A famous capital allocator may still be buying dips.

Trading interpretation: Energy equities can outperform dramatically when commodity prices, capital discipline, and investor sponsorship align.

Stock C

News signal: The healthcare proxy rose against the bear market on obesity-treatment expectations.

Rumor: Channel checks suggest demand could exceed production capacity.

Trading interpretation: Strong product-demand narratives can create defensive growth. Supply capacity may become as important as demand.

Metal D

News signal: Metal spiked on war risk, then fell under aggressive rate hikes and dollar strength before recovering.

Rumor: Gold desks say the move may be a round trip, not a clean trend.

Trading interpretation: War risk can lift safe havens, but higher real rates and dollar strength can overpower the trade.

Energy E

News signal: Energy jumped after war began, then faded as recession risk and dollar strength weighed.

Rumor: Headline prices may hide sharp regional stress.

Trading interpretation: Energy can rally on geopolitical shock but later fade if demand concerns rise. Teams should distinguish spot panic from sustained trend.

Discussion Prompts

1. Which assets are mostly macro-driven, and which are mostly company- or product-driven?
2. Which rumor would you trust least, and why?
3. How would a team hedge a portfolio that is heavily exposed to Stock B and Energy E?
4. When does Fear Gauge G provide useful information even though it is not tradable?
5. Which year rewards contrarian buying, and which year punishes it?

Student-Facing Rule Reminder

The game should present fake names only. The facilitator can use the real mapping during setup, calibration, or debrief, but revealing it during gameplay can make the exercise too easy.